PRACTICE EXAM 13 / EXAM SET 02

Domain 6: Communication and Customer Service

12 scored questions	4 answer choices per question	Answer key + explanations included

Instructions

Choose the single best answer (A, B, C, or D) for each question. Mark your responses before checking the answer key and detailed explanations at the end of this document. These practice questions are not official NHA examination items.

QUESTIONS

Q01 | Patient-Centered Communication

> **SCENARIO** During intake, a patient says, "My sister has to drive me to every appointment now. I used to do everything myself, and I hate depending on people." The patient pauses and looks at the medical assistant.

Which response best demonstrates reflective listening?

A. "Your sister sounds helpful. Have you thanked her for bringing you today?"

B. "Many people need rides. Would you like information about transportation services?"

C. "Are you saying that you would like us to cancel your future appointments?"

D. "It sounds frustrating to need help when you are used to being independent."

Q02 | Telephone Written and Virtual Communication

> **SCENARIO** During a verified telephone intake, a patient initially describes knee discomfort as constant. Before the medical assistant sends the message, the patient corrects this: "I meant it happens only when I climb stairs, not while I am resting." The assistant reads the correction back, and the patient confirms it. The message will be sent to the clinical team for review.

Which message best preserves the patient's clarified report?

A. The patient reports constant knee discomfort that becomes worse when climbing stairs.

B. The patient clarified that knee discomfort occurs when climbing stairs and is absent at rest.

C. The patient's knee discomfort improved during the call and is now limited to stair climbing.

D. The patient's account was inconsistent, so the earlier description of constant discomfort was retained.

Q03 | Accessible and Inclusive Communication

> **SCENARIO** A medical assistant is completing intake with a patient and a qualified interpreter. The patient gives a lengthy answer to an open question, but the interpreter responds only, "No concerns." The assistant is unsure whether the full response was interpreted. Clinic policy calls for complete interpretation of each speaker's message, without added advice or omitted content.

Which statement best addresses the possible communication gap?

A. "Please ask only yes-or-no questions so the answers will be easier to interpret."
B. "Please interpret the patient's complete response so I can record what they said."
C. "Please decide which parts of the response are medically relevant and relay those."
D. "Please ask the patient to give a shorter answer before we continue this interview."

Q04 | Teamwork Conflict and Professionalism

> **SCENARIO** At an outpatient clinic, a provider tells a medical assistant, "Please ask Jordan to join me in Room 4 before beginning the next intake." Jordan is available. The assistant wants to verify the request before carrying it out.

Which exchange demonstrates a complete check-back?

A. Assistant: "Ask Jordan to join you in Room 4 before the next intake?" Provider: "Correct."
B. Assistant: "I heard your request." Provider: "Please let me know once you have finished it."
C. Assistant: "Jordan is available." Provider: "Good; I will expect someone in the room soon."
D. Assistant: "I will pass along a message." Provider: "Thank you for helping with the room."

Q05 | Patient-Centered Communication

> **SCENARIO** During a routine interview, a patient looks downward while answering accurately and asking relevant questions. The patient has not expressed discomfort. A coworker later says, "They would not look at you, so they must be hiding something."

Which response best avoids an unsupported interpretation of nonverbal behavior?

A. "I will ask the patient to maintain eye contact so we can judge the answers better."
B. "I will record that the patient was evasive because the lack of eye contact was noticeable."
C. "I will ask which cultural group the patient belongs to before accepting their answers."
D. "Eye contact preferences vary; I will use the patient's responses and clarify any specific uncertainty."

Q06 | Telephone Written and Virtual Communication

SCENARIO During virtual-visit intake, a slight transmission delay causes the patient and medical assistant to start speaking at the same time repeatedly. Each person's words are clear when only one speaks. The patient says, "We keep interrupting each other."

Which statement best improves the exchange?

A. "Please give your full history without stopping; I will interrupt if I need details."
B. "I will speak more loudly so my questions stand out when we both begin talking."
C. "Let's take turns; I will pause after each question and wait until you finish."
D. "Please answer only yes or no so we can finish before the delay interrupts us."

Q07 | Accessible and Inclusive Communication

SCENARIO An older adult who is blind arrives without a companion and asks for help finding the examination room. The medical assistant introduces themself. The patient says, "I prefer to hold your arm and walk beside you." The route is clear and the assistant can provide this assistance.

Which statement best supports the patient's preferred way of receiving help?

A. "I am beside you on your right; you may take my arm when you are ready."
B. "I will take your wrist and lead you so you will not need to find my arm."
C. "Please stay here until a companion arrives to help you reach the examination room."
D. "The room is just over there; follow the direction of my voice down the hallway."

Q08 | Telephone Written and Virtual Communication

SCENARIO A patient sends a portal message asking, "Where do I park, and which entrance should I use?" The clinic's current visitor instructions identify the west parking lot and the entrance on Pine Street. Staff often abbreviate these locations internally as WPL and PSE.

Which written reply communicates the instructions most clearly?

A. "Please use WPL and enter through PSE. These are the usual patient access points."
B. "Please park in the designated lot and enter through the standard patient entrance."
C. "Please review the visitor instructions for information about the parking and entrance locations."
D. "Please park in the west parking lot and use the entrance on Pine Street."

Q09 | Teamwork Conflict and Professionalism

SCENARIO A patient complains that the reception area displays an outdated sign about walk-in hours. The medical assistant acknowledges the confusion and reports it to a coworker. The coworker replies, "We have already told patients the sign is wrong; there is no reason to change it." The assistant wants to give constructive feedback about the continuing problem.

Which statement best keeps the discussion focused on a practical service improvement?

A. "Patients should ask before relying on signs; we could add that reminder to their paperwork."
B. "The sign is still giving patients the wrong hours. Can we replace it with the approved current notice?"
C. "You should explain this complaint to the patient so they can decide whose approach is better."
D. "I will cover the sign with a handwritten schedule based on the hours I remember from last month."

Q10 | Accessible and Inclusive Communication

SCENARIO At check-in, a patient tells the medical assistant privately, "My name is spelled correctly in your system, but staff often mispronounce it. It is pronounced NAH-dee-ah." The clinic has a designated field for a pronunciation guide, separate from the verified name used for identification.

Which response best supports respectful, consistent communication?

A. "Could we use your initials during visits so staff will not mispronounce your name?"
B. "Could we replace the spelling in the identification field with a phonetic spelling?"
C. "NAH-dee-ah; did I say that correctly? I can add the pronunciation guide for staff."
D. "I will remember it today; please correct each staff member again at future visits."

Q11 | Patient-Centered Communication

SCENARIO A 9-year-old waiting for a blood draw says, "I am scared of seeing the blood." The parent says, "Tell them it will be nothing." The child can choose whether to watch, and the assistant can keep collection supplies out of the child's direct view while explaining what will happen.

Which response best acknowledges the child's concern without giving false reassurance?

A. "Seeing blood worries you. Would you like to look away while I explain what will happen?"
B. "Your parent is right; it will be nothing, so you do not need to think about it."
C. "It will not hurt at all if you keep looking at me instead of looking at the supplies."
D. "You can decide not to have the test today, and I will cancel it for your parent."

Q12 | Teamwork Conflict and Professionalism

SCENARIO A provider tells a medical assistant, "Please make sure someone checks the patient's question about the preparation sheet." The assistant contacts the nurse, who says they cannot review it before leaving. No one has accepted the request. Clinic policy requires unresolved patient communication requests to be assigned to an available responsible clinician before handoff is considered complete.

Which response best prevents this request from being lost?

A. "I told the nurse about it, so I will mark the request as handed off in the message queue."

B. "The nurse cannot take this request. Which available clinician will accept it before I complete the handoff?"

C. "I will leave the sheet on the nursing desk so whoever has time can review it later."

D. "I will interpret the preparation sheet myself so the patient will not have to wait for another clinician."

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS

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01 D	02 B	03 B	04 A	05 D	06 C
07 A	08 D	09 B	10 C	11 A	12 B

DETAILED EXPLANATIONS

Q01 | Correct answer: D

"It sounds frustrating to need help when you are used to being independent."

Reflecting the feeling and its stated cause shows that the assistant heard what matters to this patient. It also allows the patient to confirm or clarify that understanding. Immediately offering transportation resources may be useful later, but it bypasses the concern about loss of independence.

Q02 | Correct answer: B

The patient clarified that knee discomfort occurs when climbing stairs and is absent at rest.

The message should convey the patient's confirmed correction rather than combine incompatible descriptions. A clarification does not establish that symptoms improved during the call. Describing the patient as inconsistent substitutes a judgment for the specific information the clinical team needs.

Q03 | Correct answer: B

"Please interpret the patient's complete response so I can record what they said."

A neutral request for the complete response addresses the uncertainty without guessing what the patient said. The stated policy requires complete interpretation, rather than an interpreter-selected summary. Restricting the patient to shorter or closed answers changes the interview instead of resolving the missing information.

Q04 | Correct answer: A

Assistant: "Ask Jordan to join you in Room 4 before the next intake?" Provider: "Correct."

A check-back includes repetition of the specific message and confirmation by its sender. Here, the person, room, and timing are repeated and verified. General acknowledgments do not establish that the receiver understood the actual request.

Q05 | Correct answer: D

"Eye contact preferences vary; I will use the patient's responses and clarify any specific uncertainty."

Eye contact alone does not establish dishonesty, lack of interest, or a particular cultural identity. The patient is participating meaningfully, and any actual uncertainty should be clarified directly. Documenting evasiveness based only on gaze turns an observation into an unsupported judgment.

Q06 | Correct answer: C

"Let's take turns; I will pause after each question and wait until you finish."

Explicit turn-taking and a deliberate pause address overlapping speech caused by transmission delay. The scenario indicates that the words are otherwise intelligible, so increasing volume does not solve the problem. Restricting answers or requiring an uninterrupted monologue can reduce the quality of the intake information.

Q07 | Correct answer: A

"I am beside you on your right; you may take my arm when you are ready."

Describing the assistant's position and offering an arm matches the patient's stated preference while allowing the patient to initiate contact. The patient has asked for guidance and identified a workable method. Grabbing the patient's wrist or substituting vague directions disregards that information.

Q08 | Correct answer: D

"Please park in the west parking lot and use the entrance on Pine Street."

The reply answers both questions with the specific locations in ordinary language. Internal abbreviations and vague labels require knowledge that the patient may not have. Directly supplying the available information is clearer than redirecting the patient to search for it.

Q09 | Correct answer: B

"The sign is still giving patients the wrong hours. Can we replace it with the approved current notice?"

Constructive feedback connects the observed source of confusion with a specific, verifiable correction. Replacing the outdated sign with an approved notice addresses future complaints as well as the current one. Blaming patients or substituting unverified information leaves the communication problem unresolved or creates a new one.

Q10 | Correct answer: C

"NAH-dee-ah; did I say that correctly? I can add the pronunciation guide for staff."

Repeating the pronunciation for confirmation and using the designated guide supports accurate, respectful address across encounters. It does not require changing a correctly spelled identification field. An informal workaround or reliance on the patient's repeated corrections does not make the information consistently available to staff.

Q11 | Correct answer: A

"Seeing blood worries you. Would you like to look away while I explain what will happen?"

The response names the child's specific worry and offers a real, limited choice available in this situation. It does not promise that the procedure will be painless or dismiss the fear. Offering to cancel an ordered test independently goes beyond the assistant's role and the choice described in the scenario.

Q12 | Correct answer: B

"The nurse cannot take this request. Which available clinician will accept it before I complete the handoff?"

The response makes the lack of an accepting clinician explicit and seeks a definite owner under the stated policy. Passing information to someone who cannot take responsibility does not complete the handoff. An unassigned message or independent interpretation by the assistant does not resolve the communication gap.

End of Practice Exam